

LiveTimer

Instructor Getting Started Guide

What is LiveTimer?

LiveTimer is a real-time classroom timer for virtual and in-person instruction. You set timers for breaks, labs, and activities from your instructor control panel. Your students see the countdown on their phones or on a projected screen. The timer follows the student — they scan a QR code and the countdown is on their phone, so they can walk away from their desk and still know when to come back.

Getting Access

Your LiveTimer administrator will create an account for you and provide your login credentials (email and temporary password). Once you have those, follow the steps below.

Logging In

- 1 Open your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari) and go to:

<https://livetimer-classroomtimer.onrender.com/instructor>

- 2 You will see a login screen. Enter the **email** and **password** provided by your administrator.
- 3 Click **Login**. You will be taken to the instructor control panel.

Tip: After your first login, the browser remembers you — you won't need to log in again unless you clear your browser data or use a different browser.

Changing Your Password

It's a good idea to change the temporary password your administrator gave you.

- 1 Click the **gear icon** in the top-right corner to open Settings.
- 2 Find the **Change Password** section. Enter your current password and your new password, then click **Change**.

Sharing the Timer with Students

Students connect to your timer by scanning a QR code or entering a 4-character class code on their phones.

- 1 Click the **Students** tab on the instructor panel. You will see your **class code** and a **QR code**.
- 2 Share the QR code with your class. You can display it on a projected screen, share your screen in Zoom, or use the dedicated QR display page for OBS.
- 3 Students scan the QR code with their phone camera. The timer opens in their browser — no app needed. Alternatively, they can go to the LiveTimer URL and enter the 4-character code manually.

***Tip:** Each instructor has their own class code. Your students will only see your timer, not another instructor's.*

Using the Timer

The instructor panel has a phone-shaped mockup in the center that shows exactly what your students see. Text fields on the mockup are editable — click on them to type.

Quick start:

- 1 Set a duration using the hour/minute spinners on either side of the clock display, or click the clock to open the duration popup.
- 2 Type a label (e.g., "Lunch Break") and optionally a message directly on the mockup.
- 3 Click the **Play** button. The timer starts counting down on all connected phones and screens immediately.
- 4 Use **Pause** to pause, **Stop** to end, or **Restore** to bring back the last timer if you stopped it by mistake.

Timer Library

The **Timers** tab contains your timer library — saved presets you can load with one click. Click a timer name to load its settings into the mockup, or click the play button next to it to start immediately. You can create new timers, edit existing ones, and organize them into sequences that play back-to-back.

Student Monitoring

The **Students** tab shows how many phones are connected and lists each student by name. Enable **Check-in buttons** to let students report their status (Working, Done, Away). You'll see a real-time summary of who's still working and who's finished.

Need Help?

Click the ? button in the top bar of the instructor panel to open the built-in help guide. It covers every feature in detail and can be printed for reference.

First-time tip: The LiveTimer server runs on a free hosting tier. If the page takes a few seconds to load on your first visit, that's normal — the server is waking up. Once it's active, everything runs in real time.